Meeting Date: June 8, 2026

Subject: **Authorize the City Manager to Execute an Amendment to the Police Department's Axon Agreement to Include their Automated License Plate Reader Cameras**

Recommended Action

Staff recommends Council authorize the City Manager or designee to execute an amendment to the Police Departments Axon Master Services and Purchasing Agreement, to include Axon's Automated License Plate Reader (ALPR) and camera solutions through Measure Q funding that was previously appropriated for related technologies.

Background

In November 2023, City Council authorized our City's license plate reader program expansion to include 88 fixed ALPR cameras between two contracts, with one expiring May 2027, and the other expiring December 2027. In June of 2025, the Police Department entered into a 10-year agreement with Axon for police technology. Axon recently released a fixed camera with license plate reader technology that would integrate with our current software, improving efficiency for use in our intelligence center. Axon has offered competitive pricing and an opportunity to pilot the new technology at no cost.

The Police Department complies with California Civil Code Section 1798.90.5 et seq. regarding ALPR technologies. Public agencies are required to provide an opportunity for public comment at a regularly scheduled public meeting of the agency's governing body before implementing or modifying an existing program.

Discussion

Our City has experienced positive results for community safety and crime reduction because of our license plate reader program. We currently have 88 license plate readers strategically placed throughout the city focused on crime prevention. Over the last two years, they have assisted with nearly 400 cases, including recovery of missing people as well as arrests of individuals involved in criminal activity.

Axon has been a provider of hardware and software for our department for many years, and in June 2025, Council supported a 10-year renewal agreement, to include future access to newly developed technology. We have utilized Axon dash cameras with license plate reader technology for years, and they recently released their fixed camera with license plate reader technology. Their fixed solution operates in the same software as the mobile solution and more efficiently integrates in the platform heavily utilized by officers in the field and our intelligence center. All security and policy requirements governing department use will apply to these systems, ensuring best practice and adherence to state and local laws.

We are receiving two license plate reader camera options from Axon as part of the agreement. The Outpost is a compact solution, like our existing solution, and the Lightpost is a larger pan, tilt, zoom (PTZ) camera that mounts on existing city light poles. Both solutions allow live-view monitoring for critical awareness by our intelligence center, enhancing officer response for improved safety, while also utilizing vehicle license plate reader technology.

Axon is offering competitive pricing and a no-cost pilot through a phased approach for the Outpost/Lighpost solution. We will receive 40 Outpost cameras and 6 Lightpost PTZ cameras FY 26/27 for trial, and the remaining 50 Outpost cameras for trial in FY 27/28. We also receive 9 donor Outpost cameras we can share with community businesses or stakeholders to address targeted enforcement as needed. In total we are receiving 99 Outpost cameras and 6 Lightpost PTZ cameras.

During the trial phases, we will evaluate the reliability, performance and integration with existing software for efficiency, allowing us to determine the best solution for camera and license plate reader technology moving forward. Our existing license plate reader contracts and this agreement for the Axon solution align following the trial period so no additional funding is expected. This agreement also covers upgrades and support costs for the equipment throughout the agreement's full term. This agreement is structured to provide an estimated discount of $2,659,434 over 9 years, as well as additional savings from reduced contract costs compared to our existing solution.

Fiscal Impact

This agreement includes a no-cost pilot of Axon's Fixed ALPR solutions through June of 2027. If the pilot is successful, the first payment of $120,000 will be due in June of 2027. The subsequent payment of $240,000 will be in September of 2028, followed by a 4% COLA adjustment each year thereafter for the remainder of the agreement. The total estimated cost of the 9-year agreement with Axon is $2,005,283. Currently, funding is available in FY27 Measure Q funds appropriated during the last budget cycle to support the initial $120,000 payment. The remaining years of the agreement will be included in future budget requests. Staff recommends co-terming this agreement with the Department's existing 10-year agreement, which was executed in June 2025.

Summary/Conclusions

Staff is available to provide any additional information desired by the Mayor or Councilmembers.

Respectfully submitted,

Cameron Christensen
Chief of Police